nomic prosperity were possible in India before British rule—they will also be possible after British rule. In fact, under British rule, the culture and civilization of India has been suppressed, the administration has been denationalized and a land that was formerly rich and prosperous has become one of the poorest in the world.

## A New Civil Administration

When the British are expelled from India, the first task will be to set up a new Government and establish order and public security. A new Government will necessarily imply the reorganization of the civil administration and the creation of a national army. Reorganising the civil administration will be a comparatively easy task. In the past, the civil administration has always been run by the Indians and only at the top, have there been Britishers. But during the last twenty years, Indians have been gradually replacing Britishers in the highest positions. In the Central Government, the members of the Viceroy's Cabinet have been partly Indians. In the provincial Governments, since 1937, the Ministers have been all Indians and English officials have worked under them. In the highest positions wherever Indians have replaced Britishers, they have proved more capable than the latter. Indian Ministers and Indian officials know the country much better and are more interested in its welfare than Britishers. It is, therefore, natural that they should work more efficiently than Britishers have done in the past. In short, we have such a trained and experienced body of Indian officials today, that reorganising the civil administration will not be at all difficult. The new Government of Free India will only have to lay down a new policy and a new programme and furnish a new leadership at the top, for the civil administration.

## A National Army

Building up a national army will be a more difficult task. India has, of course, a large number of trained and experienced soldiers and their number has been augmented as a result of the present war. But till quite recently, the Indian Army was officered largely by Britishers, and in the higher ranks, the officers were exclusively Britishers. Owing to war-conditions, the British have now been forced to appoint a large number of Indian officers and